eGov Horizons

NOVEMBER 2026 · VOL. 22 · ISSUE 11 · SAMPLE REFERENCE EDITION

Building the Rails for Digital Governance

Inside the National eGovernance Summit 2026: platforms, procurement and public trust

PLUS In conversation with Dr. Meera Raghavan · The summit in numbers · Voices from the floor

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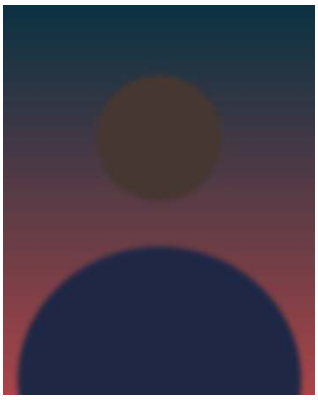
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The plenary hall on the opening morning of the summit.



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All people, organisations and quotations in this sample publication are fictional and were generated to test layout analysis.

FROM THE EDITOR

The Quiet Work That Makes Digital Government Real

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Rohan Vashisht-Menon
Editor-in-Chief

Building the Rails for Digital Governance

Two days, forty sessions and one recurring theme: shared public infrastructure only works when someone is accountable for keeping it running.

By Ananya Kulkarni-Shah · Photographs by the eGov Horizons desk



Delegates at the inaugural session of the National eGovernance Summit 2026.

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Registries before apps

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> *“Infrastructure is only public when every citizen can actually use it.”*
>
> — Dr. Meera Raghavan, Principal Secretary (IT), State of Vindhyachal

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Procurement in the cloud era

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A breakout session on registry interoperability drew a standing-room crowd.

Skills on the front line

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Procurement Without the Paperwork

State tender teams are rewriting rules written for physical servers. The results are uneven, but the direction is clear.



Vendors demonstrated sovereign cloud offerings at the exhibition.

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What changed in the tenders

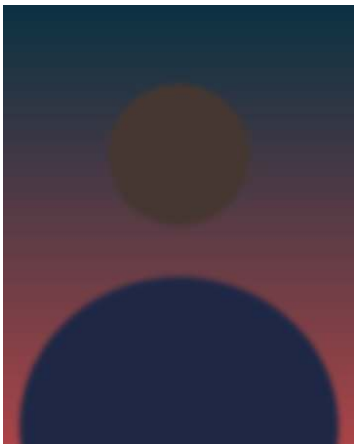
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INTERVIEW

In Conversation: Dr. Meera Raghavan

The Principal Secretary (IT) of the fictional State of Vindhyachal on registries, resilience and why maintenance is a policy decision.



Dr. Meera Raghavan at the summit.

Q. What did the summit get right this year?

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Q. What is the biggest cybersecurity risk you see today?

The discussion kept returning to a simple question: who maintains the data once the pilot funding ends and the consultants leave? The afternoon track focused on training: thousands of frontline staff need practical skills, not another certificate course. Rural connectivity remains uneven, and several speakers urged designers to build services that degrade gracefully on slow networks. Participants warned that artificial intelligence pilots often stall because the underlying records are incomplete or inconsistently coded. One municipal commissioner explained how ward-level sensors now feed a single operations room that coordinates water tankers during summer shortages.

Q. How do you measure whether a digital service is working?

Procurement teams said the hardest part of cloud adoption was not technology but rewriting tender language written for physical servers. The agriculture session showcased soil health records that farmers can now access through a voice-based helpline. One municipal commissioner explained how ward-level sensors now feed a single operations room that coordinates water tankers during summer shortages. Speakers agreed that interoperable registries matter more than any single flagship application. Several states have begun publishing service level commitments for online certificates, with automatic escalation when deadlines slip.

Q. What role should startups play in public platforms?

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“We stopped counting launches and started counting the services people finish without help.”

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Q. Where does artificial intelligence fit in your roadmap?

A finance department team shared how automated reconciliation cut the time to close monthly accounts from three weeks to five days. Industry representatives asked for clearer data residency rules so that vendors can plan sovereign cloud investments with confidence. The state health mission presented results from linking immunisation records with the birth registry across four pilot districts. Rural connectivity remains uneven, and several speakers urged designers to build services that degrade gracefully on slow networks.

Q. What advice would you give a new district collector?

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Q. How do you handle services for citizens with poor connectivity?

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Q. What would you change about procurement rules tomorrow?

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PHOTO GALLERY

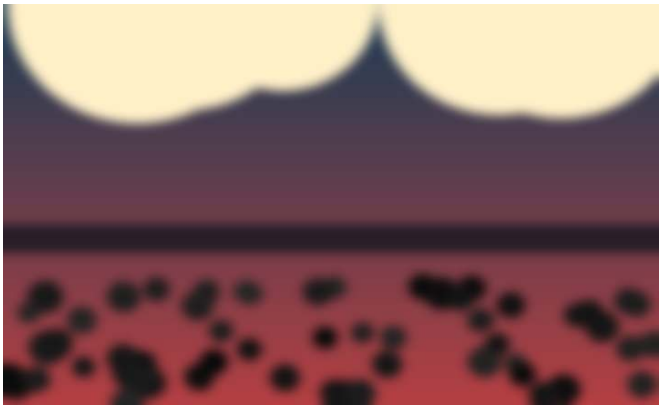
The Summit in Pictures



Registration desks opened at eight on the first morning.



A packed plenary for the inaugural address.



Exhibitors from twelve states showcased citizen services.



Panellists debate data standards for registries.

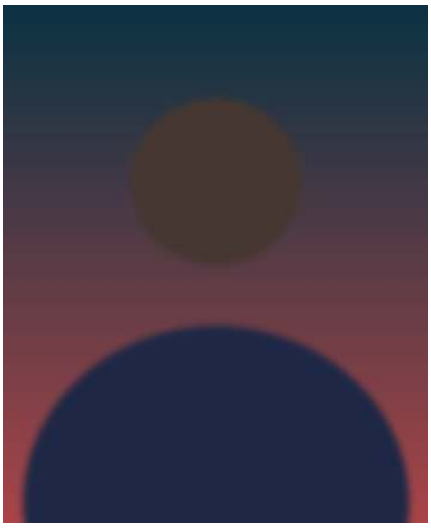


Students from a civic technology fellowship presented prototypes.



The closing plenary and announcement of working groups.

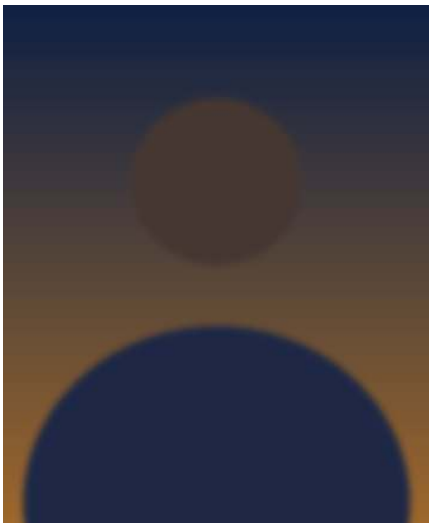
Voices from the Summit



Dr. Meera Raghavan

Principal Secretary (IT), State of Vindhyachal

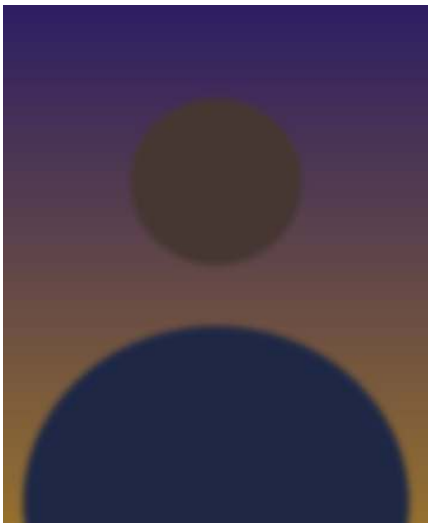
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Arjun Malhotra-Iyer

Chief Digital Officer, Coastal Metro Authority

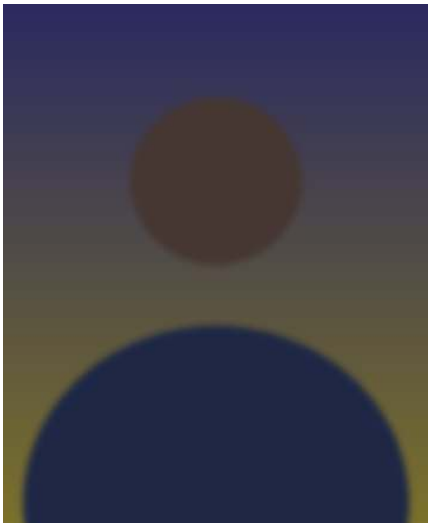
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Kavita Deshpande-Rao

Director, Institute for Public Systems

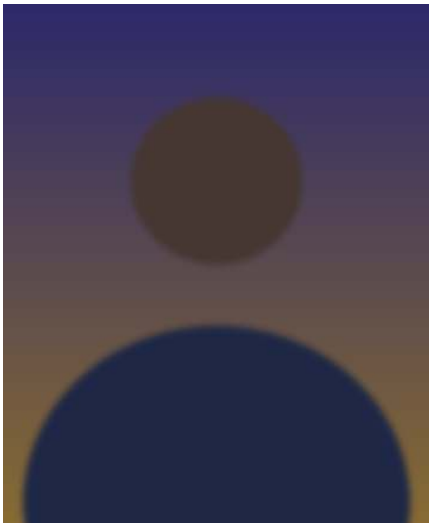
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Imran Siddiqui-Nair

Commissioner, Rivergate Municipal Corporation

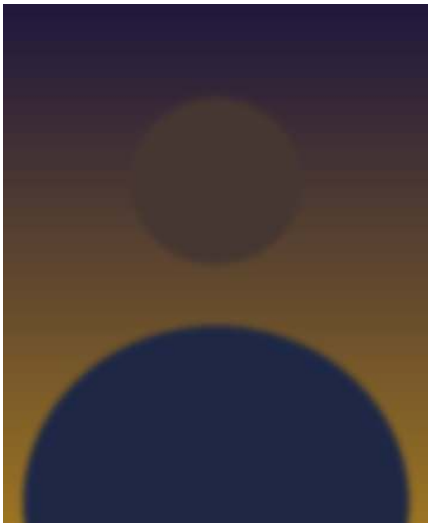
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Sunita Bhardwaj-Kamat

Head of Cyber Resilience, Fictional National Data Centre

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Thomas Varghese-Lal

Founder, OpenForms Civic Labs

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INFOGRAPHIC

The Summit in Numbers

4,200
delegates registered across two days

40
sessions in four parallel tracks

22
states and union territories represented

63%
of sessions featured a live demonstration

118
startups on the exhibition floor

9
working groups announced at the close

Sessions by track



Source: summit organisers (fictional data for this sample).

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